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r/biotech • 3y ago

PM_ME_GRANT_PROPOSAL



pfizer agrees to acquire seagen for 43bn

Really wasn't expecting to see a merger announcement today given the bank meltdowns....

<https://www.wsj.com/articles/pfizer-agrees-to-buy-seagen-for-43-billion-180a9117>

147

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H2AK119ub • 3y ago



I can't even think of the last oncology drug that was made internally at Pfizer from start to finish. Why do they even invest in R&D?



65

Reply



nithuigimaonrud • 3y ago

Tax write offs?



31

Reply



88adavis • 3y ago

This is the answer. They either spend the money on R&D or it ends up getting spent on taxes.

30

Reply



[deleted] • 3y ago • Edited 3y ago

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that work. I don't necessarily agree, but I don't disagree either. The big dogs have the resources to take a late-stage asset to market quickly, the smaller companies have the grit and creativity to approach problems without the baggage and red tape that comes with larger companies.

As far as why do they even keep R&D.. I think part of it has to be optics (they have to be able to say that they spend big dollars on research, I'm sure they also accept government dollars to do this) but also part of it is that after acquiring an asset, you need to integrate it into your existing company. You need to have folks with scientific and institutional expertise to make sure tech transfers go smoothly.

↑ 61 ↓ [Reply](#) ...



kirby726 • 3y ago

So they can say that they develop new drugs and are involved in research.

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H2AK119ub • 3y ago

"Involved"

↑ 14 ↓ [Reply](#) ...



ShadowValent • 3y ago

Once you reach a certain size it becomes fairly difficult to do innovative R&D. However, big pharma had much better resources for getting a product to the finish line.

↑ 22 ↓ [Reply](#) ...



LochTreeFiddy • 3y ago

Pretty sure Ibrance (blockbuster) was internal. They also had one of the earliest ADCs on market, though that was Wyeth at the time.

⊖ ↑ 9 ↓ [Reply](#) ...



H2AK119ub • 3y ago • Edited 3y ago

Palbociclib came from a collaboration between Warner-Lambert & Pfizer; Warner-Lambert was acquired by Pfizer for \$90 billion in 2000.

⊖ ↑ 3 ↓ [Reply](#) ...



[deleted] • 3y ago

It got shelved for years though. Essentially got picked up brand new and developed internally.

⊖ ↑ 2 ↓ [Reply](#) ...



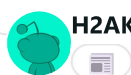
H2AK119ub • 3y ago

The drug was not made at Pfizer. It was purchased by Pfizer via Warner-Lambert and then developed by Pfizer.

↑ 1 ↓ [Reply](#) ...



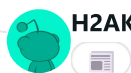
LochTreeFiddy • 3y ago

[Skip to main content](#) Create**H2AK119ub** • 3y ago

If you read the CEN article, it's because no one at Pfizer cared about the drug after they acquired Warner-Lambert (as they were focused on Pharmacia). Only after some academics published on CDK4 being essential for tumor growth did Pfizer drive it into the clinic.

**Biotech_wolf** • 3y ago

Does that also include drugs where they acquire a successful pipeline and then initiate a program for a new target using that pipeline?

**H2AK119ub** • 3y ago

If you acquire a company and integrate their discovery projects into your portfolio, I would not count that as a de novo discovery. I am referencing the lack of homegrown drugs at Pfizer. Nearly everything is an acquisition which points to the lack of productivity in their internal R&D.

**Bah_Black_Sheep** • 3y ago

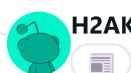
Big pharma like Pfizer seem to be able to deliver manufacturing much more reliably than the small to medium biotechs. They should probably just call it the "Development" group though.

**RandyMossPhD** • 3y ago

Agree with development prowess for sure. However, while big pharma doesn't hit often on discovery efforts I think it's important organizationally for these companies to still invest in it and have that expertise in house for other acquisitions/partnerships. And occasionally they do pull one out of their hat (eg paxlovid last year)

**RandyMossPhD** • 3y ago • Edited 3y ago

Ibrance was, and they have a bcma for MM that will get approved soon

**H2AK119ub** • 3y ago

Palbociclib came from Warner-Lambert. <https://cen.acs.org/articles/92/i19/Cancer-Drug-Class-Hits-Stride.html>

**RandyMossPhD** • 3y ago

[Skip to main content](#) Create**H2AK119ub** • 3y ago

Big pharma is just really bad at discovery. Like, 90% of their drugs are in licensed, acquired, or co-developed.

**[deleted]** • 3y ago**[deleted]** • 3y ago

Palbociclib was internal no?

**H2AK119ub** • 3y ago

No. Palbociclib came to Pfizer via Warner-Lambert.

**[deleted]** • 3y ago

Kind of. The screen was set up before they were acquired but wasn't identified until after and then nothing was developed at all until years later purely at Pfizer oncology. But I see your point.

**Proteasome1** • 3y ago

PR

**Andromeda853** • 3y ago

They barely have a sizeable team for R&D anymore

**[deleted]** • 3y ago**sounds_cat_fishy** • 3y ago

What are people's thoughts on any anti-trust issues here?

**PM_ME_GRANT_PROPOSAL OP** • 3y ago

Idk, I'm not a lawyer but if this is going through it should be OK. Remember Merck had interest in acquiring seagen last year and that fizzled out due to anti-trust issues

**heyhihellowow** • 3y ago

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with these acquisitions how often do layoffs occur? i'm wondering what this will do to seagen (working for seagen has been great, kind of strange the last 3 years profits have been negative though)

**H2AK119ub** • 3y ago

Pfizer is notorious for acquisitions only for IP. They love lay offs and re orgs.

**Other_Astronomer_182** • 3y ago

I also work for Seagen and am worried about what's going to happen in the future. Hang in there, bud

**F9_solution** • 3y ago

profits in early stage or mid-size pharma companies are always negative, because instead of sitting on the heels of the marketed drugs making a lot of money, they pump it all back into R&D and operate at a loss. good pharma companies at least.

seagen could if they wanted sit on their 1.5b per year revenue, spend nothing on R&D, live profitably, and look good on paper, then die out in a decade.

**Gold-Assistance8558** • 3y ago

Are u considering jumping ship ?

**[deleted]** • 3y ago**[deleted]** • 3y ago

This is gross. They had fucking money to buy seagen and do massive layoffs

**Yostb** • 3y ago

Have they announced it's for intellectual property and layoffs, not just incorporating them?

**H2AK119ub** • 3y ago

It's Pfizer. They always lay off the company after the acquire it.

**Barry_McCockinerPhD** • 3y ago



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